Section 3. How You Get Care

Identification cards

We will send you an identification (ID) card when you enroll. You should carry your ID card with you at all times. You must show it whenever you receive services from a Plan provider or fill a prescription at a Plan pharmacy. Until you receive your ID card, use your copy of the Health Benefits Election Form, SF-2809, your health benefits enrollment confirmation (for annuitants), or your electronic enrollment system (such as Employee Express) confirmation letter.

If you do not receive your ID card within 30 days after the effective date of your enrollment, or if you need replacement cards, call us at 800-821-6136 or write to us at:

G.E.H.A Enrollment
PO Box 21262
Eagan, MN 55121

You may also request replacement cards through our website: geha.com/My-Member-Portal.

Where you get covered care

You can get care from any "covered providers" and "covered facilities." How much we pay - and you pay - depends on the type of covered provider or facility you use and how the services are billed. If you use our preferred providers, you will pay less.

Please remember that all benefits are subject to the definitions, limitations, and exclusions in this brochure and any applicable medical or payment policies. Policies may be found on our website geha.com/Provider-Policies. In some instances, additional services may be rendered, and additional cost shares may apply.

Benefits are applied based on how your provider bills us. You must reference all Sections in this Brochure depending on where your care is obtained. For example, but not limited to, any procedure, injection, diagnostic service, laboratory, or x-ray service done in a hospital in conjunction with a physician office examination may apply separate cost share depending on where you obtain your care.

Balance Billing Protection

FEHB Carriers must have clauses in their in-network (participating) provider agreements. These clauses provide that, for a service that is a covered benefit in the plan brochure or for services determined not medically necessary, the in-network provider agrees to hold the covered individual harmless (and may not bill) for the difference between the billed charge and the in-network contracted amount. If an in-network provider bills you for covered services over your normal cost share (deductible, copay, co-insurance), contact your Carrier to enforce the terms of its provider contract.

- **Covered providers**

Covered providers are medical practitioners who perform covered services when acting within the scope of their license or certification under applicable state law and who furnish, bill or are paid for their healthcare services in the normal course of business. Covered services must be provided in the state in which the practitioner is licensed or certified.

Benefits are provided under this Plan for the services of covered providers, in accordance with Section 2706(a) of the Public Health Service Act. Coverage of practitioners is not determined by your state's designation as a medically underserved area.

We list network-contracted covered providers in our network provider directory, which we update periodically, and make available on our website.